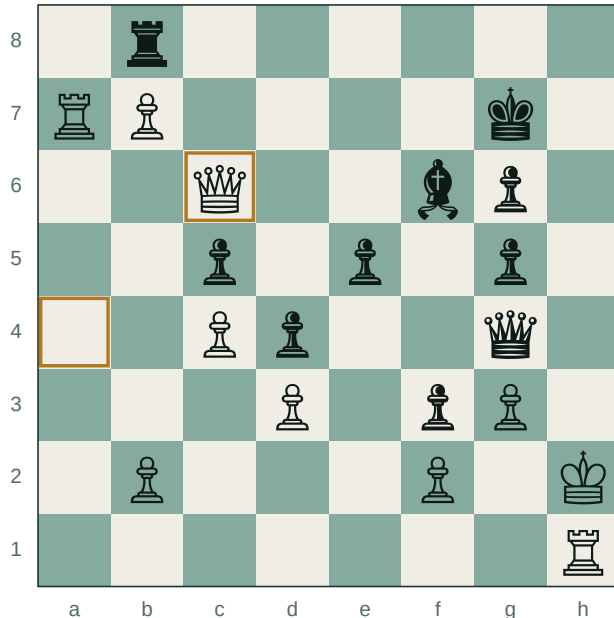


Attraction tactics: Black, move 36

Attraction tactics

Black to move



Previous move: 36.Qc6. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

36...Rh8+ 37. Kg1 Rxh1+ 38. Kxh1 Qh3+ 39. Kg1 Qg2#

36...Rh8+ Check restricts White to 1 legal reply here. Recorded reply: **37.Kg1**.

37...Rxh1+ Check restricts White to 1 legal reply here. The move also takes the rook on h1. Recorded reply: **38.Kxh1**.

38...Qh3+ Check restricts White to 1 legal reply here. Recorded reply: **39.Kg1**.

39...Qg2# Mate: queen on g2 gives check; White has no legal reply.

The line ends in checkmate against the king on g1. Material gain is unnecessary once no legal defense exists.

CHECKPOINT

Which piece delivers the final check, and why can the defender not continue? **Answer:** Queen on g2. The king is in check and the position has zero legal replies.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

The opponent may decline the offered material. Compare refusal with the recorded continuation before calling the sacrifice forced.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

Attraction draws a piece onto a square where a later tactic becomes possible. Sacrifices often work by changing the king's or queen's location rather than winning immediately.

HOW TO LOOK

Ask which enemy piece must be moved to a specific square for your next check, fork, or mating pattern to work.

The defending king is on h2. Geometrically undefended: rook on a7 and queen on c6. Check for tactical protection.